# Event Calendar

## Carnival Parade and Goa Food & Cultural Festival - (February 18-21, 2023)

Goa celebrates carnival - a three-day festival of merriment in February. King Momo, the figure head of frolic and fun,




proclaims his decree and declares his reign! A parade of colourful floats invade the streets of Panjim, Margao, Vasco and other cities during the days of carnival led by King Momo, his queen by his side. The floats depict facets of Goan culture and is preceded by youngsters dancing to the beats of lively music. Traditional occupations, village life, songs and dances are the most lively to watch. Other floats are based on themes such as global warming, deforestation, animal welfare, environmental hazards and others that convey their messages via the creativity of local artists. There are also individual characters that jest and imitate known figures. These parades are a huge draw for tourists around the world. A spirit of joi de vivre pervades the air!

Goa's Department of Tourism organises a grand Food and Cultural Festival to showcase the spirits, rich legacy and unique customs and traditions which have added colour and variety to local food habits and lifestyle. This festival celebrates authentic Goan cuisine and performances of the state's vibrant folklore and heritage. The event includes more than 50 stalls with a variety of vegetarian and non-vegetarian delicacies and brings together eminent caterers and locals serving mouth-watering dishes and traditional Goan fare with live music and entertainment over three days. Cultural programmes are also organised with live performances by famous bands. A grand display of fireworks is also one of the major attractions for tourists and locals.

## Shigmotsav and Heritage Festival - (March 8-21, 2023)

Goa also holds a parade during the Shigmo festival. It consists of floats depicting mythological characters from the Ramayana, Mahabharata and other religious texts. These larger than life figures donning dazzling costumes, combined with blinding light effects and beating of shigmo drums drive the crowds to a frenzy. One also gets to witness the cultural dances of Goa including the ghode modni, morulo, goff, divli nach, tonya mell, romot mell, kalas fugdi, dhanga and other folk dances.

**Goa Heritage Festival:** This five-day festival is celebrated to showcase Goa's rich culture and heritage. Goan artisans and craftsmen display their skills, promoting unique Goan crafts such as pottery, woodcraft, crochet, handicrafts, coconut craft, hand-painted tiles and food stalls serving traditional Goan cuisine. The entertainment programme includes Goan dance performances like dhalo, mando, fugdi, ghode modni, goff, divli dance, kunbi dance, kalshi dance, kazaracho dance, fisherfolk dance and other traditional Goan folk dances like jagor, morulo, khel tiatr, Veerabhadra, dhangar nrutya, zemado and dasarwadan.

## The Spirit of Goa festival - (May 2023)

Cashew feni and coconut feni are the twin home grown brews of Goa. The Spirit of Goa festival celebrates these spirits along with the warm and hospitable spirit of Goans. The festival was conceptualised to preserve the Goan way of life and its various art forms. This festival also brought to the fore the art of brewing feni from two of Goa's favourite food ingredients: coconuts and cashew. Both define the very essence of the Goan way of living and its culture.

This unique festival celebrates local Goan brews, distillers, infusers and is coupled with an authentic Goan food spread. Cashew stomping, felicitation of toddy tappers and some games using the coconut add to the uniqueness of this festival. Cashew feni won the GI status in 2009.

## Chikal Kalo (July 2023)

This festival is celebrated on Aashadi Ekadashi, the 11th day of the Hindu calendar which coincides with June or July in the Gregorian calendar as this month is associated with Shri Hari Vithal. This 400-year-old tradition has been celebrated in Marcel on the Devki-Krishna temple ground. During the festival, villagers assemble at the temple to enact the childhood antics of Bal Krishna through a fascinating local festival called Chikal Kalo, which literally means mud bath. The revellers celebrate with great fervour, year after year, by rolling in the mud and playing traditional games.

## Tripurari Poornima Boat Festival (November 2023)

Goa Tourism celebrates a unique traditional Tripurari Poornima festival with a boat show.

At Vithalapur in Sankhali, there is a tradition of celebrating 'deeparadhana' (lamp of fire worship) on this day. The Vithal Temple is illuminated with lamps and a palanquin procession of Lord Vithala winds its way to the river Valvanti. After deeparadhana, lamps are set adrift in the currents, resulting in a sublimely beautiful sight. Earlier, the festival was celebrated very humbly by floating earthen lamps placed in 'drona' cups fashioned out of thick dried leaves. As times changed, the old fashioned 'dronas' were replaced by more modern and artistic devices. People started making boats of cardboard and thermacol and in recent times of eco-friendly material and illuminating them with modern electric equipment. Today this has culminated in a state-level competition for the most artistic and technically superior boats. It is a matter of pride for Goans, especially from Sankhali, to take part in this boat competition.

OTHER FESTIVALS : Sao Joao; Rainforest Challenge (RFC); Bonderam; Ganesh Chaturthi; Feast of St Francis Xavier; Serendipity Arts Festival; Christmas